

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/9: Later Vedic source, chronology and eastward shift

RIGVEDIC LAYERS → SAMAVEDA/YAJURVEDA/ATHARVAVEDA → BRAHMANAS → UPANISHADS

earlier NW world ritual corpora explanation reflection/critique

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broad c. 1000-600 BCE: Punjab/upper Ganga-Yamuna → Kuru-Panchala → Kosala-Videha

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Textual sequence is relative and layered; it is not an annual political chronicle.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/9: Forest-agriculture-iron-surplus mechanism

forest edge + alluvial soils + rainfall + growing labour organisation

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iron in expanding use + heavier ploughing + cattle traction + crop diversification

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stable fields/surplus -> larger settlements -> crafts -> political extraction

CAUTION: iron helped within an ecological-social package; it did not create states alone.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/9: Jana to janapada: territorial political change

KIN GROUP/JANA -> STABLE SETTLEMENT -> TERRITORIAL JANAPADA -> STRONGER KINGSHIP

lineage loyalty	fields/claims	bounded peoples	share, force, ritual
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Assemblies persist but lose relative weight; monarchy grows without instant bureaucracy.
This bridges to Mahajanapadas, but no inevitable one-way state ladder.

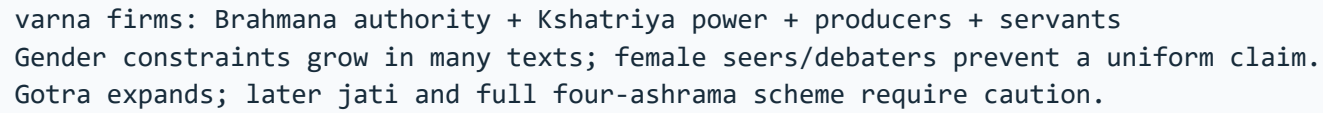
ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/9: Later Vedic political institution system

RAJAN

- |-- ratnins: politically and ritually significant figures
- |-- purohita: legitimation | senani: force | gramani: local linkage
- |-- sabha/samiti: continued assemblies with changing influence
- |-- bali and ruler share: less regular than later taxation
- +> royal rituals advertise supremacy and mobilise elite consensus

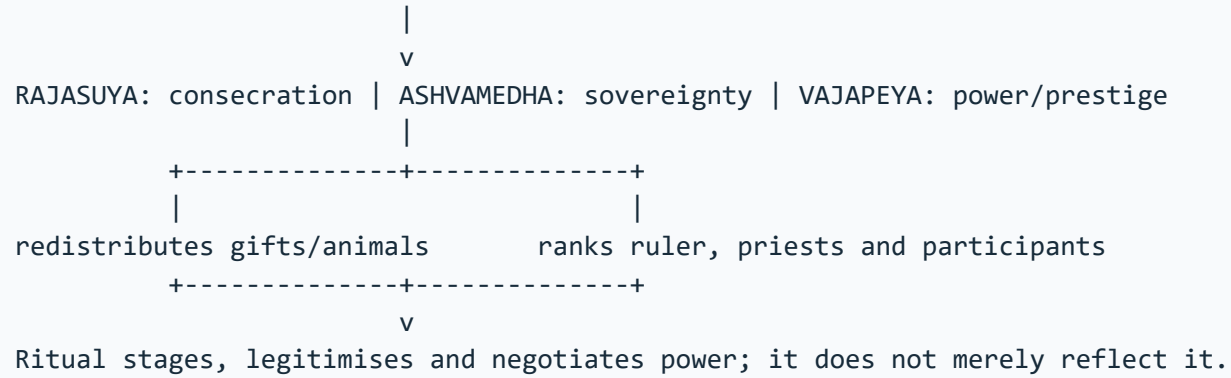
Authority grows through territory, surplus, ritual and force together.

GRIHAPATI-CENTRED HOUSEHOLD



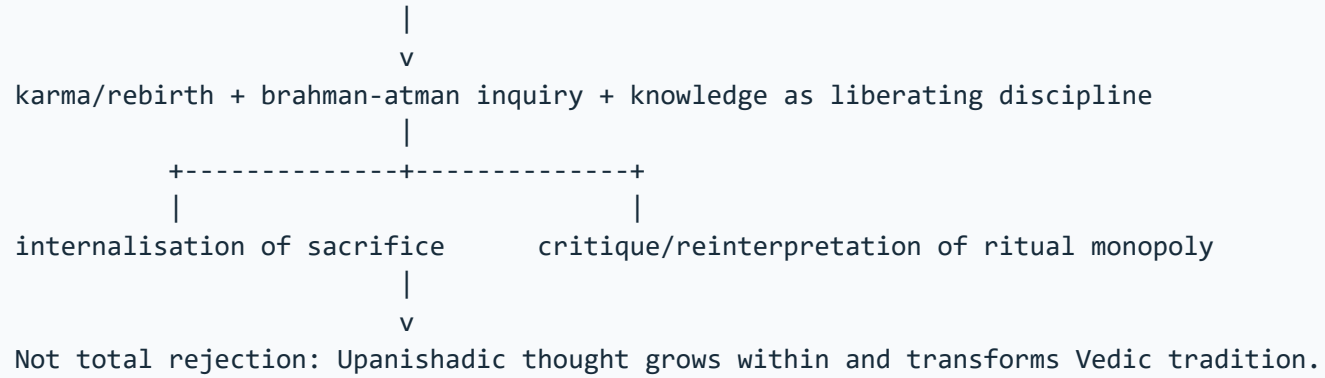
ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/9: Sacrifice as political economy

SURPLUS + SPECIALISED PRIESTS + ROYAL AMBITION



ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/9: Upanishadic turn: ritual transformed inward

PROBLEM: sacrifice promises results but leaves death, self and ultimate reality open.



ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/9: Early versus Later Vedic comparison

AXIS	EARLY VEDIC	LATER VEDIC
space	Sapta-Sindhu/NW	upper Ganga-Yamuna/eastward
polity	jana, rajan, assemblies	janapada, kingship, ratnins
economy	cattle-centred mixed base	plough farming, surplus, crafts
society	flexible differentiation	firmer varna, patriarchy, gotra
religion	deity praise/yajna	royal rites + Upanishadic inquiry
material	mixed correlates	PGW useful; not an ethnic identity

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/9: Later Vedic answer architecture

10 MARKS: identify change -> mechanism -> Vedic term/ritual -> continuity caveat

15 MARKS: source/space -> economy -> polity -> society -> religion -> PGW caution

20 MARKS: eastward ecology -> iron/agriculture -> jana-janapada -> institutions

-> household/varna/gender -> sacrifice -> Upanishadic turn -> state bridge

Avoid iron-caused-kingdoms and women-lost-all-status claims; grade evidence.

CLOSE: territoriality, surplus and ritual hierarchy deepened cumulatively.